

Will Stedden, PhD

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Dear Afresh Hiring Team,

I'm excited to apply for the Data Scientist position at Afresh. Your mission to tackle food waste and make fresh food more accessible really speaks to me—not just professionally, but personally. I feel we can't afford to waste food or time when it comes to combating climate change, and I try to live that out every day.

I've spent over 8 years in data science, working on a variety of business problems. I've come to love working with data because it's like working on a real-life detective story full of twists, red herrings, and answers that aren't where you expect them. I live for the “aha!” moments when a complex problem clicks into place. That's the energy I bring to everything I do, whether it's working on climate-focused projects or finding creative solutions to everyday data challenges.

Right now, I'm a Senior Data Scientist at Boomitra, where I lead efforts in soil carbon sequestration. We work on models and data pipelines to measure soil carbon across millions of acres of farmland. I work with cross-functional teams to define the metrics that matter most—kind of like figuring out the most important clues in a mystery—and I've had the privilege of leading the development of a fully functional soil carbon quantification pipeline. In a way, it's like I'm piecing together a puzzle to help the planet, and I'd love to bring that same mindset to Afresh, where I can help optimize your impact in reducing food waste.

Before Boomitra, I was the Lead Data Scientist at Vidable AI, where I worked on a mix of product, sales, and AI-driven projects. I built the company's first system for pulling in usage data across their entire platform and designed and built the metrics that the sales team used to quantify their success and change their communication strategy with partners. I also developed the metrics and built the monitoring system to keep track of their core technology's model performance and ensure things were working as they should.

I'm all about using data to create sustainable, impactful solutions, which is what excites me so much about the opportunity to work at Afresh. You're tackling a massive global issue that aligns perfectly with my passion for fighting climate change and food waste. I'd love to use my skills in Python, SQL, R, and Jupyter Notebooks to help you uncover the patterns that make your system work even better. The idea of using data science to change the way we manage food is honestly something I want to be a part of.

Thank you so much for considering my application. I'm looking forward to the chance to chat more about how I can bring my passion for data, sustainability, and tackling big challenges to the Afresh team. Can't wait to hear from you!

Sincerely,

Will Stedden